

AS-IR-026 · Search Interruption Review · 25 September 2026

Executive summary

Incident AS-IR-026 · 12 September 2026 · Owner: Nadia Mensah, Service Operations · Approved by: Ada Okafor, Support Assurance.

Impact and resolution

On 12 September, the Aster support-search service returned incomplete results for 47 minutes. A deployment published a new index alias before its incremental import completed. New cases remained in the source system, but 286 recent case references were absent from search. Intake and case updates continued normally.

Measure	Recorded result
Customer impact window	09:12–09:59 UTC
Affected workspace	Aster production support
Delayed records	286 recent cases
Recovery action	Restore previous alias; replay import
Confirmed data loss	None

Customer communication

The public recovery notice confirms that support search was restored and asks administrators to verify recent case visibility. This internal review adds the deployment cause, delayed-record count, investigation timeline, and remediation owners. The service manager will discuss a EUR 1,800 service credit at the next account review.

Distribution

Restricted to the Aster incident-review group. External distribution requires the service manager’s approval. The customer notice, rather than this investigation record, is the approved response to general support questions.

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Incident timeline

UTC	Event and evidence
09:08	Release SR-218 starts the incremental index import.
09:12	New alias becomes active before the import watermark is reached.
09:16	Support reports that case AST-4821 is absent from search.
09:20	On-call engineer freezes further index deployments.
09:31	Comparison against the source ledger identifies 286 delayed references.
09:43	Previous alias restored; replay starts from the last confirmed watermark.
09:59	Known-case checks pass and service is declared restored.
10:15	Customer recovery notice posted.

Detection

The availability probe continued to return success because the search endpoint accepted queries. The missing-case signal came from the support team, not from the infrastructure alert. Monitoring checked response time but did not compare index freshness against the source ledger.

Containment

The on-call engineer suspended the publication job and kept intake open. No bulk deletion or cross-workspace restore was attempted. A saved copy of the import ledger and deployment record was attached to the restricted incident case.

Validation

Support checked five recent case references and two older resolved cases. Operations compared the recovered record count with the source ledger. Both checks passed before the service-status panel was updated.

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Cause and corrective actions

Primary cause

Release SR-218 treated a completed upload as a completed import. The alias switch depended on file arrival, although the import worker could still be processing records. A slow import therefore left a valid but incomplete index visible to the search service.

Contributing conditions

The staging dataset contained only 40 cases and did not expose the import delay. The release checklist required a successful search but did not require a recent known case. Index freshness was recorded in a dashboard without an alert threshold.

Action	Owner	Due
Gate alias publication on the source watermark	Jonas Reed · Platform	18 Sep
Add a delayed-import release test	Priya Shah · Quality	19 Sep
Alert on freshness lag above 5 minutes	Nadia Mensah · Operations	20 Sep
Check recent cases before closing an incident	Ada Okafor · Assurance	16 Sep

Acceptance evidence

The next release must hold the old alias while an import is delayed, publish only after the expected watermark is reached, and return the known recent cases. Assurance will retain the release result with this incident record.

Scope of the investigation

The investigation found no modification to source cases and no evidence of another workspace's records entering Aster's index. That conclusion is limited to the reviewed import ledger and deployment window; it is not a statement about unrelated incidents.

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Recovery checklist and follow-up

Before reopening search

Confirm that the alias points to the approved index and that its watermark equals the source ledger. Run recent-case and historical-case checks as an ordinary workspace user. Keep the publication job paused until the incident lead signs off.

Check	Result	Reviewer
286 delayed references searchable	Passed · 09:57 UTC	Jonas Reed
Five recent customer cases visible	Passed · 09:58 UTC	Ada Okafor
Historical resolved cases unchanged	Passed · 09:58 UTC	Ada Okafor
Intake queue reconciled	Passed · 09:59 UTC	Nadia Mensah

Account follow-up

The account team will present the customer-facing interruption summary and proposed EUR 1,800 service credit at the 25 September review. The private delayed-record count and deployment analysis remain in this record. No customer needs to resubmit a support case.

Closure conditions

Close the incident only after the watermark gate, delayed-import test, and freshness alert are verified. Link the verification evidence to AS-IR-026. If any check fails, reopen the corrective-action item rather than marking the incident complete.

Review decision: service restored; corrective actions remain open. Next review: 25 September 2026. Record retention: 12 months after closure.